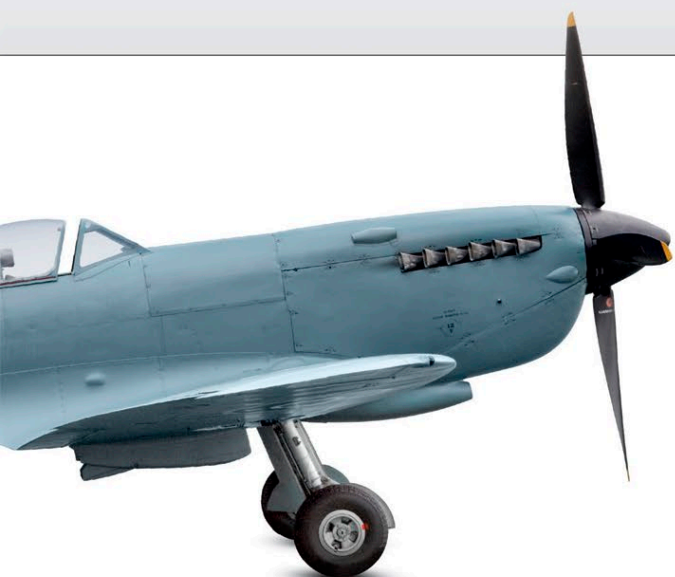




▷ Supermarine 510 1948

Origin UK

Engine 5,000 lb (2,268 kg) thrust
Rolls-Royce Nene 2 turbojet

Top speed 630 mph (1,014 km/h)

This was the first British aircraft with swept wings and tail, and the first swept-wing aircraft to operate from an aircraft carrier. The 510 prototype lacked stability, but it helped develop the Swift jet fighter.



▷ Bell XS-1 1946

Origin US

Engine 6,000 lb (2,722 kg) thrust
Reaction Motors XLR11-RM3
liquid-fueled rocket

Top speed 967 mph (1,556 km/h)

The first aircraft to exceed the speed of sound in level flight, XS-1 was powered by a rocket with very limited burn time. Air-launched to maximize flying time, Chuck Yeager hit Mach 1.06 on October 14, 1947.



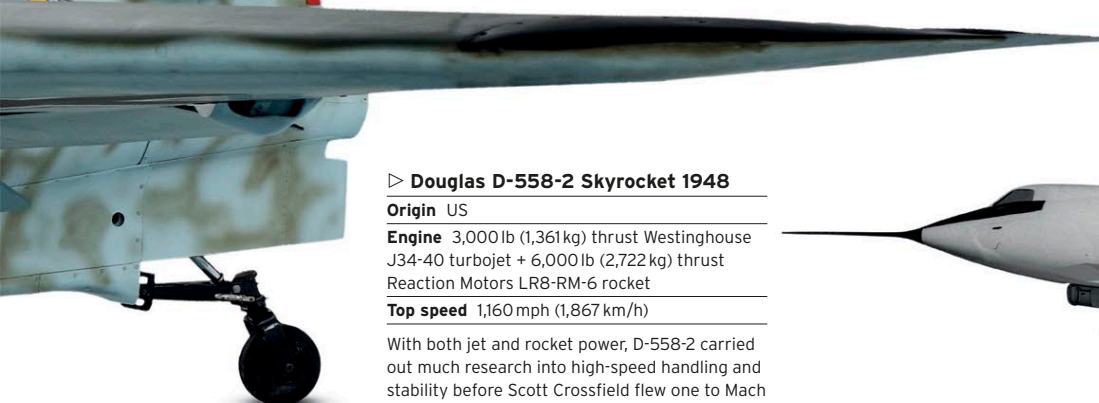
△ Leduc 0.10 1946

Origin France

Engine 3,520 lb (1,597 kg) thrust
Leduc ramjet

Top speed 500 mph (800 km/h)

René Leduc's remarkable pioneering work on ramjets was carried out under the nose of German occupiers during WWII, finally reaching fruition postwar. Launched from the air, it reached Mach 0.85.



▷ Douglas D-558-2 Skyrocket 1948

Origin US

Engine 3,000 lb (1,361 kg) thrust Westinghouse
J34-40 turbojet + 6,000 lb (2,722 kg) thrust
Reaction Motors LR8-RM-6 rocket

Top speed 1,160 mph (1,867 km/h)

With both jet and rocket power, D-558-2 carried out much research into high-speed handling and stability before Scott Crossfield flew one to Mach 2 for the first time ever on November 20, 1953.



◁ Hawker P1052 1948

Origin UK

Engine 5,000 lb (2,268 kg) thrust
Rolls-Royce Nene R.N.2 turbojet

Top speed 683 mph (1,098 km/h)

The P1052 was a test aircraft with 35 degree swept wings, of which two were completed for research into swept-wing aircraft characteristics. Several changes were made to the tailplane during the test program.

▷ Saab J 29 Tunnan 1948

Origin Sweden

Engine 6,070 lb (2,753 kg) thrust Volvo
Aero RM2B turbojet

Top speed 607 mph (977 km/h)

Nicknamed the "Flying Barrel," the J 29 formed part of Sweden's robust postwar air defense. Influenced by German WWII research, it was one of the first swept-wing fighters: fast, agile, but not quite supersonic.

